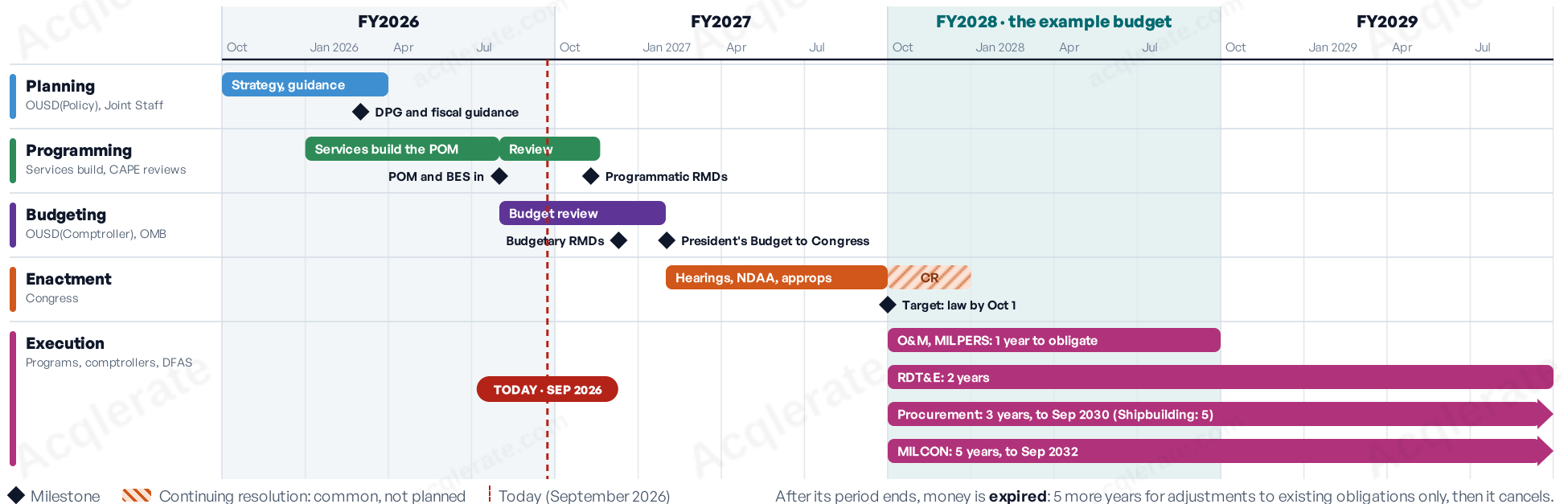


The PPBE Cycle on One Page

How a defense dollar goes from strategy to spent. Follow one budget, FY2028, from first planning meeting to last day on contract.



Right now: four budgets at once

BUDGET	WHERE IT IS IN SEPTEMBER 2026
FY2026	■ Execution. One-year O&M money expires Sep 30. Multi-year FY2026 money keeps going.
FY2027	■ Congress. Starts Oct 1. With no appropriation, a CR holds most programs near last year's rate.
FY2028	■ Program and budget review. POM and BES are in. RMDs this fall, President's Budget in February.
FY2029	■ Planning starts. Guidance for the POM the Services build next year.

Who owns each phase

PHASE	LEAD	WHAT COMES OUT
■ Planning	OUSD(P), Joint Staff	DPG, fiscal guidance
■ Programming	Services, CAPE	POM, a 5-year plan; RMDs
■ Budgeting	OUSD(C), OMB	BES, RMDs, President's Budget
■ Enactment	Congress	NDAA authorizes; appropriations fund
■ Execution	Programs, comptrollers	Obligations, spending, reprogramming

What it means for a PM

- **Two years of lead time.** Money you need in FY2028 had to be in the POM built in 2026. A late requirement waits a cycle or competes for reprogramming.
- **Fight in the programming window.** Spring and summer of the POM year is when priorities move. In execution you manage what you got.
- **Under a CR:** no new starts and no production-rate increases unless Congress grants an exception.
- **Obligate early.** One-year money not on contract by Sep 30 is gone for new work.

Reform watch. The Commission on PPBE Reform (final report, March 2024) called for more flexibility, and DoD has since asked for higher reprogramming limits and some two-year O&M. Check the current appropriations act for what Congress actually enacted.